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amazon freight partner

Operations Manual

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Introduction

Welcome to the Amazon Freight Partner (AFP) Program!

This manual helps you understand AFP requirements and provides resources to build best-in-class trucking operations and a safe, high-performing culture for your business success. The most recent version of this manual is available in the AFP Resource Center. If you have any questions, don't hesitate to reach out to your Business Coach or Middle Mile Partner Manager for assistance. See the "AFP-supporting teams" section below for more information. In this manual, 'you' or 'your' or 'partner' means the AFP, and 'we' or 'our' means Amazon.

Introduction to the AFP Program

The AFP Program aims to build a fast, reliable transportation network that exceeds customer expectations while enabling small business success. Amazon partners with independent small businesses (AFPs) to collectively meet customer needs through long-term opportunities with consistent work and stable revenue commitments. We require zero upfront capital to lease sustainable, state-of-the-art Amazon-branded tractors. The program supports partners by managing tractor maintenance, providing consistent driver schedules, and offering exclusive value-added services to reduce costs. This allows partners to focus on recruiting and retaining drivers with dependable hours, competitive wages, healthcare insurance, and paid time off.

Amazon responsibilities

Each AFP is independently owned and operated. You are responsible for ensuring your company complies with all federal, state, and local laws and regulations. Amazon is not responsible for individual AFP operations. This manual references program policies from the AFP Program Terms of Service ('Program Agreement') you agreed to when joining the program. We may audit your company periodically for compliance with the Program Agreement, related policies, and applicable laws. Guidance in this manual that is not a Program Policy or agreement provision is a suggestion or recommendation, not a requirement.

Note on confidentiality

This manual contains Amazon confidential information and must not be disclosed to third parties per the Program Agreement.

Your company may access proprietary Amazon information (prototypes, tools, policies, contact information) and participate in pilots or testing – all of which must remain confidential. Do not disclose details to anyone not involved in the pilot, including coworkers, family, or friends. Per the Program Agreement, AFP owners and employees must not share Amazon confidential information with anyone unaffiliated with the Amazon contract. Share confidential information only on a need-to-know basis within your company. Do not post customer information on social media or share passwords or login credentials related to your Amazon contract.

Amazon leadership principle

Amazon employees use the [Amazon Leadership Principles](#) every day, whether we're discussing ideas for new projects or deciding on the best approach to solving a problem. Because your company will be collaborating with Amazon employees, understanding these principles can help you appreciate our operating practices.

A culture of safety

Everyone at Amazon shares ownership in creating a safe workplace, and we invest in resources to help our partners thrive. We are constantly evaluating new technologies and learning opportunities to optimize how leaders build capabilities, receive critical safety information, and prepare to meet future challenges. Safety is integral to everything that we do at Amazon – every day, in every operation, across every country. We invest, invent, and innovate in safety, going above and beyond the basics for our transportation partners.

Diversity, equity, and inclusion

At Amazon, we are committed to building a workforce that enables us to build the best products and services for our global customers, communities, and partners from a broad range of backgrounds, cultures, and experiences. We believe we make better decisions, invent more, and deliver more for customers when we learn from the unique backgrounds, experiences, skills, and perspectives of our teams. We also know the future of work is being written right now, and we're committed to empowering Amazon employees and the broader workforce to thrive in a rapidly changing labor market.

AFP-supporting teams

Several Amazon teams support AFP success:

1. **Fleet Strategy:** Manages tractor supply, specifications, pricing, and orders. Owns strategic fleet improvements (alternative fuels, advanced safety technology) and communication with truck manufacturers.
2. **Transportation Risk and Compliance (TRC):** TRC's mission is to assist partners in operating in a manner compliant with the highest transportation, contractual, legal, and regulatory requirements. TRC conducts various audits (e.g., wage/benefits compliance, Hours of Service (HOS), driver eligibility, etc.) and helps AFPs identify and reduce risk to AFP business and to Amazon. If TRC identifies a potential compliance issue, they will share findings with your BC/MMPM. At times, TRC may issue a Corrective Action Plan (CAP) or other notification that will explain areas of non-compliance and the steps required by the AFP to remedy the identified concern.
3. **Value Added Services (VAS):** Negotiates deals with providers of tractor insurance, medical insurance, fuel cards, parking, driver wellness programs, legal assistance, and other services to reduce AFP onboarding friction and operating costs.
4. **Business Coach (BC):** Your primary point of contact for your lifecycle in the program, your BC will provide guidance on strategic issues relating to business health, driving hiring, compliance, flexible work, and contract size. Your BC's objective is to help make you successful, indispensable to Amazon customers and the Amazon network.
5. **Middle Mile Performance Manager (MMPM):** Your primary contact for executing loads and tactical/operational issues. Your MMPM meets with you weekly or biweekly to coach on day-to-day operations and performance metrics (rejections, on-time performance, safety, compliance). Provides program updates and serves as your main point of contact for questions and escalations, and will assist you to navigate and work with cross-functional teams in the Amazon Transportation Services network.
6. **Relay Operations Center (ROC):** Your behind-the-scenes team that helps you keep things moving when disruptions happen. The ROC team monitors delayed loads, resolves tour disruptions, recovers capacity, and

manages equipment issues on your behalf. They also handle severe events, provide Relay app support, and connect you with Driver Support Services (DSS) when your drivers need help.

- 7. AFP Safety:** Your partner in building a strong safety culture. The AFP Safety team works with you through education and coaching to help reduce risk across your operation. They assess your hardware, software, assets, infrastructure, and operational standards to help identify opportunities for improved safety and compliance performance. They also use technology and data to identify potential safety risks early so you are enabled to respond appropriately.
- 8. Maintenance Centralized Services (MCS):** The MCS team in the ROC coordinates vendor assignment for both scheduled and unscheduled maintenance requests, inspections for vehicle handoff/return/reconditioning, and has a dedicated team for AFP escalations related to maintenance and invoice submission review. MCS is a 24x7 support team with one shift in Tempe, AZ (US Daytime) and 2 shifts in Hyderabad, India, for overnight support on unscheduled maintenance repairs.
- 9. Fleet Asset Specialist (FAS):** The FAS team are field leaders at the site level who partner with Amazon Freight Partners (AFP) to drive uptime by coordinating with on-site vendors and OEMs. They conduct vehicle inspections, drive escalation resolution, and can assist with any fleet-related questions.
- 10. Transportation Operations Management (TOM Team):** The TOM team is responsible for the yard operations of an Amazon facility and monitor the yard for safety. If you have any questions or concerns while on an Amazon yard, approach the TOM team for assistance.

AFP Program operating hours

The Amazon network operates 24/7 year-round, with the exception of the Fourth of July, Thanksgiving day, Christmas day, and New Year's day holidays (subject to change).

Amazon high-volume events

Amazon's delivery volume spikes during peak season (mid-November through December 25) and promotional events like Prime Day (Amazon's largest global shopping event for Prime Members, typically held in June or July). AFPs may experience increased load opportunities during these periods to help Amazon meet the customer promise. These days are very important to our business, and we rely on partners to complete load deliveries. We encourage you to prepare to scale up during.

Business setup

Creating your business entity

Every US-based AFP must be established as a legal business entity in the United States prior to signing the Amazon AFP Program Agreements. If you have not already created a business entity, you must complete this step as soon as possible so you can finish the AFP onboarding process on time.

Note: Any future changes to business entity information must be provided to Amazon in writing 30 days in advance.

Choose your business entity type

Amazon requires you to establish your company as **1) an S corporation, 2) a C corporation, or 3) a Limited Liability Company**. We do not recommend one option over another, as each owner's situation is unique. Please consult your legal, accounting, or tax advisor for more information on selecting the appropriate legal entity classification for your business needs.

Select a company name

You will be associated with the company name you select. We recommend choosing a name that makes you proud because it will appear throughout Amazon's systems and in other areas of your business (on employee paychecks, for example). Many owners select a name that connects them with trucking, while others select a name that highlights their uniqueness. When choosing your name, remember that you can't violate any criteria listed below. If you select a name that violates one of the following criteria, Amazon may require you to change your entity's name. Changing the company name during the onboarding process may cause launch delays and additional costs, such as filing fees to your state's office and the Internal Revenue Service (IRS).

Some naming requirements:

1. Avoid using a name or branding that is the same or similar to that of any Amazon trademarks. For example, don't use ALEXA, AMAZON, AMZN, A-Z, ECHO, GLOBAL LOGISTICS, HALO, PRIME, SCOUT, SMILE or the Smile Logo, or any similar variations or combinations of these marks. You can verify overlap by checking ['Non-Exhaustive List of Amazon Trademarks'](#) and compare your proposed company name with Amazon trademarks.
2. Avoid using a name that is the same or similar to that of any Amazon programs or services, such as 'Amazon Freight Partners' or 'AFP.'
3. Avoid using a name that is inconsistent with AFP Program requirements or values.
4. Avoid using a name that is inappropriate or may be offensive.
5. Search for the company name you have chosen on your state's website to verify that the name is available.

Create a business email address

Once setup of your company's legal business entity is complete, create an email address for the business. The recommended best practice is to incorporate your business name into your email address.

Register for an Employer Identification Number

You're required to obtain an Employer Identification Number (EIN) from the IRS before you can continue the Amazon onboarding process, open a corporate bank account, or be paid by Amazon. You can apply for an EIN

through the IRS website. You should wait to create your EIN until your business entity has been confirmed by your state.

Designate a registered agent

When creating your business entity, you must designate a registered agent to receive official mail, including service of process, at a physical address (not a PO Box) in your company's state of incorporation or formation.

You have two options:

1. **Self-designation** – You can be your own agent if you have a physical address in the state of incorporation (which doesn't have to match your operating state).
2. **Paid agent** – For a fee, your attorney or another individual can act as your agent. If your registered agent changes address or you change agents, update this with the Secretary of State or applicable governmental body in your state of formation. Consider paying for an agent if you lack a permanent address. Be cautious about using your home address, as this information will likely be public on the state registration website.

State and local licensing

During the creation of your business entity, you may be offered a report detailing the state, city, village, and town licenses that may be required based on your company location. You should research these licensing requirements and visit your state, county, village, city, and town websites to learn more about licensing requirements specific to small businesses in your area.

Business bank account

Your company should open a commercial checking account at the bank of your choice to keep your business revenues and expenses in an account separate from your personal finances. This account will be used to track your start-up and operating expenses and can be linked to your accounting software. The details of the account must be provided during onboarding to set up automated payments from Amazon. After opening a business bank account and receiving a link to Payee Central (explained further in the next section), you will be able to input your bank account information. You'll be asked to enable two-factor authentication for additional account security and provide your bank account information.

Payee Central overview

Payee Central is a self-service, online portal designed to assist you with setting up your payment method with Amazon

Important: Please complete Payee Central account setup and your tax Interview four weeks prior to your launch date to ensure that Amazon can issue your first payments on time.

Information required for Payee Central account setup:

1. Address affiliated with your business
2. Banking information
3. Tax details.

If you run into any questions throughout the Payee Central or the tax interview process, please work with your assigned Business Coach. Within a week of providing your point of contact with your company name, you'll receive an email with a Payee Central link (sent to the email used in the interview process). Check your spam folder if you don't see it in your inbox. Follow the link in the email to access Payee Central.

After opening the Payee Central link from your invitation email, enter the email address that received the invitation. On the sign-in page, use your existing Amazon.com account credentials if you have one with that email. If not, select 'Create your Amazon account' and enter your name, the invitation email address, and a password. Once logged in, enter the activation code from your Payee Central invitation email, review the terms, and select Accept to access the Payee Central account summary page.

Payee Central account setup

1. After clicking on the **'Start Setup'** button, you will be prompted to provide a **One-Time Password (OTP)** for verification purposes. Check your email that received the Payee Central invitation, and you should have recently received a new email with the OTP. The OTP will be valid for 20 minutes.
2. You will be asked to enter your **Contact Information**.
 - **Address Line:** Enter the address that you used when setting up your business.
 - **Contact Email Address(es):** List the preferred email(s) that the Payee Central team can use to reach you. You may enter multiple email addresses by separating them with a comma. If you use multiple email addresses, all email addresses will receive Payee Central communications.
3. Next, you will complete your **Payment Information**:
 - **Pay Term:** This field will remain as '7 NET.'
 - **Account Nickname:** Do not include your bank account information in this field.
 - **Bank Location:** Please select United States.
 - **Preferred Currency:** Please select USD.
 - **Payment Method:** This field will remain as 'Electronic.'
 - **Bank Account Type:** Define whether your bank account type is 'Checking' or 'Savings.'
 - **Account Holder Name:** This will be the same name that is associated with your bank account. If this information does not exactly match the name associated with the bank account, we may not be able to deposit payments to your account.
 - **Remittance Email:** List your preferred email(s) where you would like your payment remittance information to be sent. You may enter multiple email addresses by separating them with a comma. If you use multiple email addresses, all email addresses will receive Payee Central communications. You will be requested to enter your remittance email again to confirm the data provided.
4. Once complete, click on **'Save'** and proceed to the tax interview by selecting **'Take Interview.'**

Completing the tax interview process

After you select **'Take Interview,'** you will first be asked to provide your tax classification. Select whether your tax classification is 'Individual' or 'Business' after reviewing the steps below. You will also be asked to confirm whether you are a US citizen. Select 'Save and continue' once complete.

Important: When selecting your tax classification, keep in mind:

- Individual – Use this field if you are a Single-Member LLC where the owner (you) is an individual.
- Business – Use this field if you classify as a Multi-Member LLC.

If you select 'individual' tax classification (single-member LLC), follow the steps below:

1. If you selected **'Individual'** as your tax classification, you will be asked for your **Tax Identity Information**.
 - a. Enter your **'Name'** as shown on your income tax return. If you are a Single-Member LLC, enter your first and last name (in the 'Name' field) with your Social Security number in the 'TIN' field.

- b. You will have the option to enter your **'Business or trade name.'**
 - c. Enter your **'Address'** information in the appropriate fields. This address will be used if we ever need to mail you information. Select **'Done'** to confirm the information.
 - d. Enter your Social Security number in the **Tax Identification Number (TIN)**. Please do **NOT** add spaces or dashes when you enter your Social Security number. .
 - **Reminder:** Single-Member LLCs should enter their first and last name in the 'Name' field, and their social security number in the 'TIN' field.
 - Select the appropriate option from the drop-down based on your inputs above (SSN or TIN).
 - e. Click **'Continue'** to advance to the final step where you will be prompted to **sign and submit** your tax profile.
2. On the next page, you will be prompted to **sign and submit** the tax interview on the following page.
 3. At the bottom of the page, type your full name in the **'Signature'** box. Finally, click **'Save and Preview.'**
 4. The final page will be a summary of your inputs, which you can save for your records. In case there are any errors, you will be alerted on the final page.

If you select 'business' tax classification (multi-member LLC), follow the steps below:

1. If you selected **'Business'** as your tax classification, you will be asked to confirm your **Federal Tax Classification**.
 - a. Select your **Federal Tax Classification** type from the dropdown. If you don't know your Federal Tax Classification, call the IRS Business Assistance Line (800-829-4933) to confirm your corporation type.
 - b. Enter your **'Name'** as shown on your income tax return. The same name should appear on the top line of the address on your CP575A notice from the IRS. This is typically your business entity name.
 - c. You will have the option to enter your **'Business or trade name.'**
 - d. Enter your **'Address'** information in the appropriate fields. This address will be used if we ever need to mail you information. Select 'Done' to confirm the information.
 - e. Enter your **Tax Identification Number (TIN)**.
 - f. **Multi-Member LLCs registered as a Corporation (C or S Corp)**—enter your name and EIN found on your CP575 notice from the IRS.
 - g. Select **'Continue'** to advance to the next page. .
2. On the next page, you will be prompted to **sign and submit** the tax interview on the following page.
3. At the bottom of the page, type your full name in the **'Signature'** box. Finally, click **'Save and Preview.'**
4. The final page will be a summary of your inputs which you can save for your records. In case there are any errors, you should be alerted immediately.

Confirming tax account status

- If you've provided an electronic signature, in most instances, your tax profile will be validated immediately. If your tax identity information came back as invalid, here are some things to consider:
- If you are completing the tax identity information as an individual (if you have a Single-Member LLC), use the information exactly as it appears on your Social Security card.
- If you are completing the information as a business (Multi-Member LLCs), use the name that appears on the top line of the address on your CP575A notice from the IRS.
- If your tax identity information comes back as invalid, try taking it one more time. Go back through the tax interview process and confirm you entered the correct information based on your business type. If you continue to run into issues with completing the process, reach out to your Business Coach, who can provide assistance.

Tax Interview Tip: During the tax interview, you can hover over the 'I' icon to assist in answering general questions while you're taking the interview.

Finalizing your account information

Once you have saved your address, banking and remittance email, and submitted your tax information, please check the box confirming the following: 'I hereby confirm that the submitted information is correct and agree that Amazon will not be liable for any missed or erroneous payments resulting from submitting incorrect information.' and click the **'Submit'** button. Once valid, your account will be set up on Amazon's Accounts Payable system. Please work with your assigned Business Coach on any questions or issues when completing this process.

Amazon Relay

Amazon Relay (relay.amazon.com) is the hub of your AFP Program business operations and allows you to manage your AFP account, onboard and schedule your drivers, and view your completed work and payments. Relay is accessible via the web as well as through the mobile app, on both iOS and Android devices.

For partners who own a carrier company that already has access to Relay, you'll use the same account when you join the AFP Program. For partners new to Amazon, you will receive an invitation to join Relay during your onboarding process.

Payroll and time tracking

Amazon-negotiated payroll deal

Amazon negotiates deals with ADP to offer competitive rates on payroll processing, employee scheduling, and time tracking for the AFP Program. These packages include required modules per the Program Agreement. Contact ADP using the designated methods below (general customer service representatives lack knowledge of Amazon AFP Program requirements).

Unless otherwise specified in writing by Amazon, adopt ADP's payroll and time-tracking software and allow Amazon to access your company's payroll and other data per the Program Agreement Section 20(d).

Contact ADP as soon as possible to begin implementation—it can take up to four weeks.

ADP AFP Dedicated Support Team:

- Eastern Standard Time: (844) 365-2736
- All Other Time Zones: (844) 365-2746
- Email: ADPAmazonSupport@adp.com

Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration

Operating authority – Motor carrier (MC) and U.S. Department of Transportation (DOT) registration

Amazon requires all AFPs to obtain and use a motor carrier number (MC) and US DOT Number (USDOT) in operations of your business. If your company does not have existing MC or USDOT, you will need to apply for them on the [FMCSA website](#).

Motor carrier number application

The USDOT number is assigned immediately after application is submitted and approved. The MC number must be approved and confirmation is sent at a later date that the number has been issued. Failure to submit insurance will delay the approval of the MC.

Amazon requires that your company obtain an MC before launch.

The [FMCSA questionnaire](#) will walk you through the application process on the FMCSA website. The FMCSA application requires your EIN that was provided when you established your company and a list of the corporate officers in your company.

Once you have submitted your application to the FMCSA, you can check on the status of your MC# by visiting this [link](#).

Note for California-based AFPs: Please research 'California MCP' for more information on the California Motor Carrier Permit (CA-MCP) requirements.

When to start the motor carrier approval process

As a recommendation, your company should target starting the MC approval process upon offer to give yourself enough time for the approval process while allowing for the possibility of a slight launch delay. Your operating authority in the AFP Program is tied to your MC being approved, which is important for program compliance. Additionally, it is recommended that AFPs bind insurance within 90 days of your company's FMSCA application or your operating authority, including your MC, may be involuntarily revoked by the FMCSA. The approval process takes approximately one to two weeks. As a suggestion, your insurance should become effective at least one week prior to program launch in order to have it in place for receipt of your vehicles.

What to do with conflicting guidance: If you receive guidance about DOT requirements that differs from AFP Program Policies, please bring it to the attention of Amazon's TRC team at afpcompliance-trc@amazon.com

Post-application solicitations

Shortly after you complete your application, you may be contacted by companies trying to sell you certain services, such as process agent services and insurance. These soliciting companies may have access to the information you provided in the FMCSA application. Before purchasing any services, we recommend discussing them with your Business Coach to determine whether such services are required under the AFP Program or offered as a value-added service under the program.

Process agent

After registering for your company's DOT and MC numbers, your company is required to engage a process agent. Your process agent will receive legal documents from any state and forward them to your business address. The FMCSA requires companies registered with the DOT to have a process agent authorized in all 50 states, even though you may only operate in one or two. There are many companies that provide process agent services.

Select a process agent to file for you in all 50 states from the [FMCSA process agent page](#) and verify that your agent completes Form BOC-3. Consult your tax, accounting, or legal advisor if you have questions.

Best practice: Call a few process agents on the list to make sure you are getting a good price. Costs may vary widely depending on the selected vendor.

International Fuel Tax Agreement (IFTA)

The International Fuel Tax Agreement is an arrangement among US states and Canadian provinces for the disbursement of fuel taxes collected. This agreement simplifies fuel tax collection by state, by allowing a motor carrier to register an account in a single state. That account is then used to redistribute taxes paid at the location of fuel purchases to the states where fuel was consumed. All Amazon-owned tractors will operate under Amazon's IFTA account.

Unified Carrier Registration (UCR)

What is UCR? From the FMCSA website, UCR is as follows: "Created by the Unified Carrier Registration Act of 2005 (UCR Act—49 United States Code (USC) section 14504a), it replaces the former system for registering and collecting fees from the operators of vehicles engaged in interstate travel—the Single State Registration System (SSRS)." Every entity subject to UCR is required to register annually with its base state and pay an annual fee to that state. AFPs classified by the FMCSA as interstate commerce are subject to the UCR registration. If your company is based in a location that does not participate in the UCR program (Arizona, Florida, Hawaii, Maryland, Nevada, New Jersey, Oregon, Vermont, Washington, D.C., and Wyoming), you are still required to register per FMCSA regulations.

International Registration Plan (IRP)

The Commercial Motor Vehicles (CMVs) used in the AFP Program are owned and registered to Amazon. AFPs do not need to register for an IRP account or add the AFP CMVs to an existing account.

Heavy Vehicle Use Tax (HVUT)

The Commercial Motor Vehicles (CMVs) used in the AFP Program are owned and registered to Amazon. HVUT fees for AFP Program vehicles are paid by Amazon.

Electronic Logging Devices (ELD)

ELD are required by the FMCSA. As part of the AFP Program, your company is required to have and maintain a functioning ELD in each tractor used to perform services for Amazon. ELD will be installed in each AFP tractor prior to each tractor handoff. If for any reason an ELD stops functioning, your company is responsible for troubleshooting the device and ensuring its operation. For application functionality you will be provided direct customer support number while if there is a device issue and the device needs to be replaced you will need to contact DSS.

Other state and local requirements

You may be required to apply for a business license and/or other permits with other authorities (including with respect to transportation of property) in the jurisdiction (state, borough, city, town, parish, village, etc.) in which your company will operate and/or pay local taxes. Please consult your tax, accounting, or legal advisor to determine which local business licenses, permits, authorities, and various taxes may apply to your AFP Program business.

Other operational requirements, needs, and information

In this section you will find information on how to sign up for various operational needs and value-added services – benefits negotiated by Amazon with third-party vendors and offered to help your company reduce operating costs. The AFP Resource Center is a hub that provides easy access to the latest AFP Program news, announcements, and resources. We recommend you bookmark it.

Amazon Asset Insurance Program (AAIP)

Amazon provides insurance coverage for Amazon-owned, leased, and rented tractors and trailers operated in the AFP Program. AFPs do not need to acquire auto liability (including physical damage) or cargo liability coverage for Amazon-branded tractors.

For non-program equipment your company uses to perform motor carrier services which are unrelated to the AFP Program for Amazon, you must obtain: (1) Auto liability of at least \$1,000,000 per occurrence (2) Physical damage coverage with \$50,000 limits for Amazon trailer assets (3) Cargo insurance with at least \$100,000 limits.

All AFPs must secure: Workers' compensation insurance (or equivalent) (2) Commercial general liability insurance (at least \$1,000,000 per occurrence and \$2,000,000 aggregate) (3) Employer's liability insurance (at least \$100,000 per occurrence). The AAIP policy has a \$2,500 upfront cost recovery fee for physical damage claims regardless of fault. You're responsible for damages up to the upfront cost recovery fee and may need to reimburse the applicable claim management company for claim-related damages.

For existing AFPs

McGriff is your insurance broker for Amazon-owned assets.

- Contact: 844-818-6243 or MCG.AFPSupport@MarshMMA.com

For new AFPs

McGriff will contact you to discuss Program Tractor and Trailer insurance. Have ready: motor carrier information (DOT #, SCAC, Motor Carrier name including DBA, driver information if available) and start date. You may obtain a Workers Compensation (WC) and General Liability (GL) quote from any broker or provider; McGriff can also provide a WC and GL quote.

Once policies are in place, McGriff's insurance company will activate your authority by filing the MCS-90/BMC91X endorsement. After verification, McGriff will provide a Certificate of Insurance (Col).

For all AFPs

If WC or GL coverage is purchased from a broker other than McGriff, submit a certificate of insurance evidencing commercial general liability coverage that is compliant with the Program Agreement section 2 to support@certifical.com. Certifical is a service used by Amazon to monitor for continuous compliance with AFP Program insurance requirements. Submit new certificates whenever policy changes occur.

Netradyne

As an Amazon Freight Partner, you will operate within a safety-first, performance-driven program supported by Netradyne's in-cab technology. This AI-powered system monitors driver behaviors such as fatigue, distraction, following distance, and lane discipline, providing real-time audio alerts that allow drivers to immediately self-correct. It also captures detailed event data and video, enabling targeted coaching and continuous improvement across your fleet. Partners gain operational visibility through dashboards that highlight safety trends, performance metrics, and coaching opportunities. Final onboarding includes driver orientation and coaching setup to ensure the system is used effectively from day one. More information can be found in the AFP Resource Center.

Fuel-Comdata

Amazon has partnered with Comdata to provide AFPs with fuel discounts across 150,000+ fueling locations in the US by using the Comdata Mastercard. Amazon funds fuel cards on a weekly basis and covers the cost of fuel. For fueling using Comdata fuel cards, all your drivers must use the "Driven for Comdata app" to locate Amazon preferred fuel vendors. Once you have applied for your Comdata account for the AFP Program, you should hear back from the company in approximately one or two business days.

If you run into trouble setting up your account, you may contact Comdata directly.

- Email: afpsupport@comdata.com
- Phone: (800) 897-8796

Background check account-First Advantage

All AFPs and their employees accessing Amazon locations will have to pass Amazon background checks conducted through First Advantage (FADV). These background checks are paid for by Amazon, but the process is managed by AFPs in Relay. In addition, your company will need to register a FADV account. More information can be found in the AFP Resource Center.

Door decals

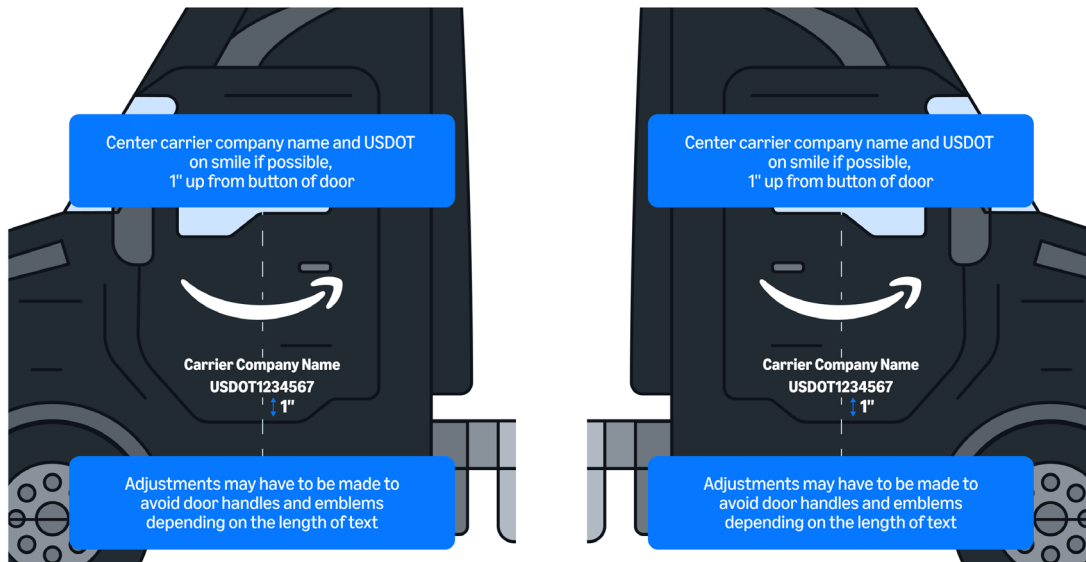
The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) requires door markings on CMVs to meet specific standards. As a benefit of the AFP Program, all AFPs will have access to order preapproved decals for the program fleet.

The following is a link to the full CFR: [§ 390.21 Marking of self-propelled CMVs and intermodal equipment.](#)

Your company is not permitted to make any externally visible modifications to any Program Tractor or Trailer Assets, including paint changes, stickers or decals of any kind besides our required door decals, visible displays from cabs of flags or other messaging. To comply with FMCSA and the Program Agreement, please use the process detailed in the AFP Resource Center.

Decal and markings installation

To ensure you install your company decals properly on the Amazon-branded tractors, please follow the directions that arrive with your company's decal order. Below is a visual of where the decals should be placed on each tractor door. Do not add anything outside of the decals shown in the visual (e.g., no company logos, messages, etc.).



AFP Training

As part of the AFP Program, both you and your company's employees may be expected to complete various training modules per AFP Program Policy. Training will be delivered primarily electronically through a learning management system. More information can be found in the AFP Resource Center.

Operating your company

Business launch and ramp plan

AFPs typically start with three tractors and six drivers, receiving tractors the week before first tendered loads. Companies grow from three to at least 10 tractors through weekly contracts, based on meeting eligibility requirements. Growth speed depends on domicile tractor availability, launch timing, and your ability to scale operations. Your BC will discuss your launch and ramp schedule during onboarding. Launch date is when you're ready for first tendered loads; the ramp plan schedules increases through three, five, seven, and 10 tractors. AFPs typically ramp to 10 tractors over seven weeks, though expedited timelines may be requested.

Communicating with your company's BC and MMPM

Stay in touch with your BC and MMPM during your ramp period. Keep them updated on:

1. Your progress and comfort level with the business and Amazon operations
2. Driver hiring and training status
3. Any roadblocks in building processes for service, safety, and compliance.

Contact your BC one week before your ramp date to confirm new contracts are loaded and no blockers exist for adding routes.

Recruiting timelines

We recommend you start recruiting drivers at least four to six weeks before launch and each ramp event. Plan for two drivers per tractor, though many AFPs hire more to account for attrition and to create scheduling flexibility. See the Driver Recruiting Playbook (page 14) for guidance.

Eligibility for increasing tractor count

Your eligibility to increase tractor count depends on whether your company is meeting service, safety, and compliance standards. These standards include:

1. On Time Performance Load percentage
2. Tender Acceptance
3. Safety Technology Scores
4. Adherence to policies and audit requirements listed throughout the Program Agreement
5. Importantly, regardless of eligibility, your domicile must support the requisite volume to add AFP capacity prior to eligibility being established.

Performance requirements: Your company is expected to implement programs to maintain the highest level of performance possible, including 100% On-Time Performance, Tender Acceptance, and Relay mobile application use. For the minimum scores required across our key performance metrics, refer to our Program Agreement. If you're struggling to meet these standards during your ramp period, Amazon may slow down your ramp schedule until you are able to build processes that enable you to meet these standards.

For questions regarding ramp and growth potential, please contact your BC. For questions on how performance is calculated and what impacts performance, please connect with your MMPM.

AFP operations

In the following sections you will find information on the day-to-day operations of your company.

Safety culture

Operating a safe fleet starts with establishing a culture of safety for your AFP. These key elements can help you to establish a strong safety culture during the hiring process:

1. **Set high standards** – your selection criteria should include minimum standards for driving experience, tenure, and a safe driving record. As a best practice, consider drivers with at least two years of prior experience and a driving record with no serious moving violations and no more than three minor moving violations within the last three years.
2. **Get an employment application** – A completed application with detailed information about past employers and driving history can help provide the information you need to meet your hiring standards. Pay special attention to employment gaps and any accidents or moving violations disclosed in the application.
3. **Review Motor Vehicle Records (MVR)** – An MVR lists a driver's motor vehicle convictions in a given state and can help determine if an applicant has a record of moving violations or accidents. Drivers with multiple minor moving violations, serious preventable accidents, or serious moving violations during the past three years may not be good candidates for a driving position.
4. **Review Pre-Employment Screening Program (PSP)** – A PSP report contains a driver's most recent 5 years of crash data and the most recent 3 years of roadside inspection data from the FMCSA Motor Carrier Management Information System (MCMIS) database. MCMIS is a federal government database, which is different from the state data sources used to generate Motor Vehicle Records (MVRs). The PSP includes original violation regardless of whether it resulted in a different conviction. Compare this information to the employment application and investigate any discrepancies.
5. **Contact previous employers and review Department of Transportation (DOT) performance:**
 - DOT rules require motor carriers to contact previous employers to inquire about an applicant's safety record and drug and alcohol testing history. Even when past employers are reluctant to respond, basic information such as dates of employment, type of work performed, and eligibility for re-employment can be helpful.
6. **Interview** – An interview offers the opportunity to get to know the applicant and to learn about his or her past driving experiences and safety record. Ask open-ended questions to encourage the applicant to talk freely. Consider involving several people in your company in the interview process to get a balanced assessment. The interview is a great time to set expectations with the driver to see if this would be the best fit for them.
7. **Conduct and document the road test:**
 - It's easy to assume that someone with years of driving experience is a safe driver. But if this were true, only inexperienced drivers would have accidents. A road test can help provide insight into an applicant's temperament and safety awareness behind the wheel. Establish a road test route that assesses how the applicant handles a variety of driving situations, and test the driver in the type of environment that will be most challenging IE: urban congestion during rush hour instead of interstate driving during midday. Keep all records relating to the driver screening and selection process. These can be used to create a complete picture of an applicant's qualifications. They can also help you compare applicants more effectively. These records can help demonstrate that you have exercised care in screening and selecting qualified, safe drivers. Many of these records must also be kept in the driver's DOT qualification or safety performance history files.

For general safety-related inquiries and concerns, please email afpsafety@amazon.com.

Vehicle variance and safety features

Our Amazon-branded tractors are equipped with some of the latest safety technology to aid drivers in operating vehicles safely.

Some examples include: Forward Collision Mitigation, Blind Spot, Fatigue Alerts, and Lane Departure Warnings.

Because AFP's fleet comprises several manufacturers, or Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEM), of different makes and models, these safety features may vary from tractor to tractor. It's important that all drivers familiarize themselves with these safety features prior to operating over the road.

FMCSA Behavior Analysis and Safety Improvement Categories (BASICS)

One way that Amazon assesses safety is through FMCSA's Behavior Analysis and Safety Improvement Categories (BASICS), which scores carriers on seven categories:

- Unsafe driving
- Hours of Service (HOS)
- Vehicle maintenance
- Driver fitness
- Controlled Substances
- Crash indicator
- Hazardous Materials

Based on violations during roadside inspections, all US DOT carriers are ranked in percentiles and results of individual inspections and violations are publicly available.

Amazon monitors five categories and has the following maximum thresholds for percentile scores:

- Unsafe Driving (60th)
- Hours of Service (60th)
- Driver Fitness (75th)
- Controlled Substances/Alcohol (75th) and Vehicle Maintenance (75th)

The AFP Safety team partners with AFPs and provides coaching and resources when thresholds. Your BASIC scores are tracked on the Compliance, Safety, and Accountability (CSA) [website](#) and result from law enforcement findings during roadside inspections. It's important to understand the impact of violations and citations and prepare drivers for inspections. The results of their inspections will impact not only your BASICS scores but also your Inspection Selection Score (ISS).

Your ISS score is used at roadside inspection stations to help inspectors identify and prioritize safety inspections by placing every carrier into one of three groups:

- **Inspect** – Top Priority
- **Optional** – next level priority
- **Pass** – Inspection not warranted

More information on roadside inspections can be found in the AFP Resource Center, and additional information on BASICS and ISS can be found on the FMCSA's [website](#).

Safety training

Monthly safety training: Each month, Amazon provides AFPs with computer-based training modules tied to current safety trends. AFPs are required to ensure their drivers complete these modules by the end of the month.

Smith System Defensive Driving Excellence Program: Amazon has worked with Smith System to make their Defensive Driving Excellence Program available to AFPs as an optional, Amazon-funded benefit for partners who want to build lasting safety training capabilities in-house.

For participating partners, Amazon cover:

- One trainer certification (4–5 day course, ~\$3,000 value)
- Annual 5 Keys Engage Trainer Portal licensing (\$600/year)

Once certified, your trainer can deliver flexible training sessions to your entire fleet – with no per-driver cap. Training formats include one-on-one (4 hours), small group up to 3 drivers (6 hours), and standard group up to 5 drivers (8 hours). Participation is optional. We encourage you to take advantage of this opportunity to build a lasting safety culture at your company.

To learn more or express interest, email AFP-smith-system@amazon.com.

Yard safety

Please ensure you follow all the yard rules for each site and observe the following tips for yard safety:

1. Do not hook on red-lit dock doors: Amazon staff are actively loading and unloading trailers.
2. Wear a Class 2, high-visibility safety vest at all times.
3. Look out for pedestrians while driving. Stay alert and avoid distraction.
4. Follow the yard speed limit: five miles per hour/eight kilometers per hour.
5. If on foot in the yard, maintain a safe distance of at least 20 feet from operable vehicles. Assume you are in the blind spot of these vehicles.
6. Don't touch or tamper with yard equipment.
7. Smoking, idling, and littering are prohibited in a yard. In addition, children and pets may not be outside a vehicle at a yard at any time. Phone use and headset use is also prohibited unless your vehicle is stationary and you are in your cab.
8. Report all incidents (injuries, vehicular accidents, and/or spills) to Amazon via site personnel, Relay Operations Center (ROC), or Accident Reporting Center (ARC). See page 35 for details.
9. Don't tailgate! Never use someone else's badge to enter the building. Without proper identification you will not have access to Amazon facilities.

Driver-specific yard safety

These are some driver-specific tips for yard safety:

1. Slide tandems to the rear position (this may vary with intermodal containers).
2. Exercise caution around pinch points—such as wheels, between trailers, and near the loading dock—where vehicles could move or roll. Set your brakes and/or use chocks, and communicate when working with helpers or spotters.
3. Physically inspect that the kingpin has fully engaged with the fifth wheel during the coupling process. Perform a tug test.
4. Fully engage tractor and trailer parking brakes before leaving the cab: Failure to set brakes can cause a tractor rollaway, leading to incident or injury.
5. Keep your keys with you at all times.

Helpful numbers

- Accident Reporting Center (ARC): 1-856-333-6510
- Relay Operations Center: (ROC) 1-866-203-8372

Accidents and reporting

In the event of a vehicular, safety or any other type of incident (examples include, but are not limited to fatalities, injuries, damage to vehicles requiring a tow, assault, robbery, theft, physical or verbal threats or harassment, property damage):

1. Ensure that your company's personnel performing services are safe
2. Call 9-1-1 in the case of an emergency

Immediately notify Amazon (regardless of severity or fault) by requesting a call back through the [Support Center](#) on the Relay portal.

Reporting to ARC through the Relay portal and app

Partners have a callback request option in the [Relay portal](#), while drivers have this functionality in the Relay app, available on both [iOS](#) and [Android](#):

Instructions for partners:

1. Open the Relay portal
2. Navigate to the 'In Transit Trip Issue (Request a Callback)' option in the Relay portal [Support Center](#)
3. Include a synopsis of the issue type as well as your phone number within the callback request form so a specialist can contact you to quickly resolve your issue

Instructions for drivers:

1. Open the Relay app
2. Go to the Support Center
3. Select 'Request a Callback'
4. Enter the phone number for callback
5. Select the callback reason from the list of options

Driver view in Relay

After you or your company's driver submits a callback request, an AFP-trained Relay Operations Center specialist will call the driver back promptly.

Driver recruiting playbook

Disclaimer

The purpose of this guide is to provide best practices and suggestions for driver recruiting and guidelines on job postings and examples for your recruiting efforts. If you move forward with these examples or parts of these examples, please remember to update the text to meet your company's individual needs. Your job advertisements should clearly indicate that you are the employer and the source of the advertisement. You may not use phrases such as "Amazon is hiring," use any Amazon trademarks or logos, or otherwise imply that Amazon is the employer.

Build your employer brand

Building a strong employer brand is critical to your hiring strategy. Your employer brand is how prospective hires, customers, and partners perceive your company—shaped by how you operate and what employees say about you. Ask yourself:

- What values does your company stand for?
- Why should someone want to work for you?
- Are you visible to prospective drivers?
- How can you leverage current employees and their networks to attract talent?

How do you build your employer brand?

Develop your employee value proposition

Your employee value proposition outlines the reasons why a driver or other employees should work for your company. What are the monetary and non-monetary rewards that your company can offer to potential drivers? This information should be incorporated into how you talk to prospective drivers. It is important to create and communicate employee value that extends beyond monetary compensation. We've learned that candidates place value on the more intrinsic benefits of driving for an AFP like predictable work schedules and wide range of job types including home daily and home every two days. You can develop a short survey to ask your current employees about why they work for you and what they think about your company. You can ask them what they might tell their friends and family about your company and which aspects of working for your company they enjoy the most.

Social media is a great place to start in terms of building an online presence. It's free to create a page for your business on multiple websites. This gives your prospective hires the opportunity to learn more about your company and a way to express interest in open positions.

Develop a hiring strategy

Individuals are always free to choose the right employment opportunity for them, and it is critical that you develop a compelling offer that attracts high-quality driver candidates. Develop a hiring strategy tailored to your fleet size, location, and business needs.

Focus on your recruiting pipeline: applicants > invites > interviews > offers > compliance checks (background checks and driver qualification files) > hires. Track conversion rates at each stage to understand how many applicants you need per hire.

Key considerations:

1. **Driver to tractor ratio** - Plan how many drivers per tractor based on your growth stage, fleet size, and location. AFP tenders six 14-hour blocks per tractor weekly. For example, a 3:2 driver-to-tractor ratio allows four shifts (52 hours) per driver weekly.
2. **Attrition** - Account for drivers leaving or taking time off by hiring extra drivers to fill scheduling gaps.
3. **Shift preferences** - Multiple drivers per tractor provide scheduling flexibility, reduce burnout, and lower attrition, ultimately decreasing hiring needs.

Write your job description

Once you've determined the number of drivers you need to hire, it's time to craft your job description. A job description is your prospective driver's first impression of your company and is the easiest way to communicate the duties and responsibilities needed for your open position. It's the primary touch point for drivers applying to your job so it's important to get this right.

Purpose of the job description

A job description is used to document important job functions to prospective candidates. It outlines the necessary skills, and job details such as schedule and wage. It will be used for recruitment, selection, training, performance evaluation, and helping to determine the candidate who best meets the qualifications.

Before writing your job description, think about the following

1. Are you clearly conveying what role and shift your company is seeking to fill?
2. What about your job description is going to get the prospective driver engaged or excited? This could include benefits
3. What will you do to sell candidates at every touch point?
4. How can you proactively source candidates?
5. How can you set expectations in the job description about the role you're hiring for?

Writing your job description

Once you've thought about your hiring needs, it's time to write your job description. As your company is creating it, think of how you want to introduce your business and attract qualified drivers. The most important aspects of a job description include the following:

1. **Job title:** Make sure your job title is specific and clear for what job role you're recruiting for. A 2020 Indeed survey found that 36% of job seekers search for a job using the title of the job they're looking for. Best practices include sharing key details that will resonate with your audience.
- Example:

Job Opening: CDL Driver Paid Weekly AM Shift

- Shifts are consistent; start between 5 am Monday - Friday, finish between 3:30 pm and 6 pm

2. **Shifts:** It's helpful to include shift details in the headline using this format: 'Class A CDL Driver
 - **Day Shift:** Local shift that gets driver home daily, with shift hours operating during the day
 - **Night shift:** Local shift that gets driver home daily, with shift hours operating during the night
 - **Solo1:** Home daily after 14-hour shifts
 - **Solo2:** Shift will require two days but home every two days (38hr shifts)

- 3. Job summary:** Think about an attention-grabbing summary. It should provide an overview of your company and expectations for the position. The summary is where you can add unique details about why a candidate should work for your company. Remember to include a location. If you are hiring for multiple shifts, add a section titled 'shifts' and write each available shift.

Shift availability:

- Day Shift (Preferred)
- Night Shift (Preferred)
- Overnight Shift (Preferred)

- 4. Salary and benefits:** The contractual minimum wage required by Amazon is a floor, not a ceiling. You should set wages at a competitive level depending on the hiring market in your area. You can include a range for the salary, which will help you stand out from other employers and help attract best-fit candidates. We recommend displaying your company's starting pay in this format: 'Compensation: Starts at \$X yearly take-home pay + benefits + safety bonus.' If you choose to list the hourly rate, we recommend you project what that hourly rate would be for a full year's worth of work. For example, 'Hourly rate starts at \$X per hour,' or 'Starts at \$X yearly take-home pay.' Consider including a list of the benefits your company offers. Most job decision to accept an offer. Each AFP owner must independently determine its hourly wages. You should not discuss wages with other AFPs or agree with them on wage levels. Employee compensation and benefit information is sensitive and discussions or exchanges of information about any element of employee compensation is prohibited.
- 5. Responsibilities and duties:** You can highlight the day-to-day activities of the position and describe the core responsibilities of a driver working for your company. Your list should be detailed but also concise.
- 6. Qualifications and skills:** Make sure to list the most important qualifications and skills required for the role.

Recommendations for writing a job description

Amazon has learned through partner feedback about the most effective elements to include in a job description for an AFP Commercial Driver's License (CDL) driver:

1. Communicate the days of the week and the estimated start times that your drivers will work so there are clear expectations.
2. If your company offers sign-on, safety, performance, or other types of bonuses, be sure to include that information—with appropriate qualifiers.
3. You can mention that your company is an Amazon Freight Partner but you cannot imply that Amazon is the employer.
4. Clearly list all the benefits that your company offers including health insurance and paid time off.
5. Include specific descriptions like 'Home Daily' or 'Home every other day' in the job title.
6. Strike a casual tone so drivers perceive you as friendly and human.

Keep in mind

Do not imply that Amazon is the employer. Example of acceptable language:

1. [Company Name], an Amazon Freight Partner, is hiring full-time CDL A drivers
2. Move freight for Amazon Freight Partner, [Company name].

Examples of unacceptable language:

1. Amazon is hiring

2. Work for Amazon

For questions on what is and is not acceptable? Contact your MMPM/Business Coach for details.

Amazon expects that your company will comply with federal, state and local anti-discrimination laws, any state and local 'ban the box' laws, and any other laws that impact the hiring process.

- Some states have adopted 'ban the box' or 'fair-chance' policies, which may prohibit employers from asking questions about conviction history on job applications and/or during part or all of the interview process. Please consult your legal representative/Ogletree with any questions for your location. This guidance is not intended as legal advice to any AFP.
- Federal, state, and local employment laws prohibit employers from publishing job advertisements that show a preference for or discourage someone from applying for a job because of their race, color, religion, sex (including gender identity, sexual orientation, and pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, genetic information, or any other protected characteristic. For example, a help-wanted ad that seeks 'females' or 'recent college graduates' may discourage men and people over 40 from applying and may violate the law.
- Questions on what is and is not permissible? Contact your legal representative or Ogletree for details.

Avoid the following:

- Including physical requirements not essential to job function
- Explicitly or implicitly discouraging applicants in protected categories from applying (e.g. age, gender, sexual orientation, and so on)
- Exclusionary language that is not required by law.

Sample job description—Please note the bracketed items are variable text for you to update.

The benefits listed in this informational guide are examples only. When listing wages and benefits in job postings, remember that AFPs must independently set wage and bonus amounts to remain competitive.

Sample job posting (Sample below is for Solo1. Sample job posting for Solo 2 and Long Range driver can be found in Resource Center)

Class A CDL Drivers for Amazon Freight Partner (Home Daily/Local, up to \$XX/ year)

Compensation: <\$XX-\$YY> yearly take-home pay + benefits

Sign-On Bonus: <\$XX>

Weekly Schedule: <Days of Week, Estimated Start Time>

Location: <City, State>

Shift: <Day, Night, Home daily, On the road one day or two days>

<Company Name> is hiring full-time, motivated Class A CDL drivers with a clean driving record for its Amazon Freight Partner program. We are a local small business with the benefits of a large company. We haul exclusively for Amazon and are making on-the-spot job offers contingent on eligibility and background check requirements. Please call or text <Phone Number> and apply today <link>.

What you'll do:

- Haul Amazon loads (primarily no-touch freight) using state of the art **Amazon-branded equipment** and **technology**, including brand new tractors
- Drive local and regional routes that have you home after every shift
- Work a minimum of 42 hours per week (3 shifts of 14 hours each) with **opportunities for additional shifts and overtime**
- Play an important and respected role in keeping Amazon's commitment to **exceed customer expectations** and deliver packages on time and at the right place

Why you'll love working for an Amazon Freight Partner:

<Consistent Schedules>: You will work a minimum of <X shifts of xx hours every week> with consistent work all year and have opportunities for additional shifts and overtime.

<Home Daily/Or Every two days>: <Solo1: You will be home after every shift, enabling you to spend more time with family and friends.>/<Solo2: Round-trip routes: 36-hour shifts> (Length of trip can vary and you can let the candidate know in the posting)

Predictable Earnings: With hourly pay and consistent schedules, you'll have earnings that you can count on. We offer competitive pay starting at \$XX-\$YY per hour. Our drivers average \$XX- \$YY take-home pay every year.

Compelling Benefits: We offer W2 employment with paid time off, health and dental insurance, and 401(k).

What you'll need:

- Must be at least 21 years old
- Have a valid Class A Commercial Driver License (CDL)
- Must successfully pass DOT physical
- Must be able to speak, read, and write in English to communicate with the general public, to understand highway traffic signs and signals, to respond to official inquiries, and to make entries on reports and records
- No current CDL suspension or revocation
- Clean Motor Vehicle Record
- Successfully pass a background check
- Must pass a pre-employment drug screen
- Must be able to use handheld technology and smart phone applications such as GPS

Contact: <Name>, <Phone Number> or <Email Address>

You will not be employed by Amazon. Instead, you will work directly for a local transportation company that partners with Amazon.

We are an Equal Opportunity Employer. All qualified applicants will be considered for employment regardless of age, national origin, race, color, disability, religious beliefs, sex (including sexual orientation), or genetic information (including family medical history).

Now that you have completed your job description, you can upload it to external websites (see section below) as well as Amazon-sponsored sites to promote to your prospective candidates. Optimize with any one of the suggested channels below.

Online sourcing channels

There are many online channels to source CDL drivers. Partner feedback indicates that Indeed, Craigslist and ZipRecruiter tend to be the top sourcing channels for recruiting CDL Class A drivers. Amazon also has worked to provide support in sourcing drivers by creating a resource to promote a company's open roles. In addition to posting job descriptions on these websites, we recommend creating company profiles or pages so that candidates can learn more about your company and what you have to offer.

AFP Jobs: Amazon provides a free resource for US-based partners to post their job description to attract potential candidates. Amazon leverages paid media campaigns to promote jobs posted on this site at no cost to your company.

Visit <https://afpjobs.amazon.com/> to view your job postings (jobs are posted through Fountain).

Offline sourcing channels

Offline channels can be a powerful way to attract candidates. Job seekers trust their personal networks.

- 1. Referrals and word of mouth:** Referral programs are on the rise. Research shows that referred new hires are often a better fit for the company, more engaged, and less likely to leave. In a recent Jobvite survey, almost 40% of hires originate from employee referrals. Employees hired through employee referrals are hired 55% faster than those who come through a career site. Typical referral programs include incentives, feedback, and recognition. You can consider giving your drivers business cards or flyers that they can use to share information about your company. Develop an incentive program to reward drivers who refer candidates to your company.
- 2. Truck driving schools:** While we understand some partners may be limited by their insurance in terms of hiring new recruits out of driving school, we still recommend forming relationships with your local schools so that you can build awareness with the local CDL driver community in your area.
- 3. Local businesses and truck stops:** Partners have shared that posting flyers at local businesses and at truck stops have been successful. Ask your friends and family in the community to post flyers on your behalf.
- 4. Partnership with 3P recruitment agencies:** We have established partnership with 3P recruitment agency, Total Talent Advisors (TTA), to provide white glove driver hiring service (sourcing, screening, interviewing) to AFPs at a pre-determined cost. This agency source candidates through multiple vetted channels, including a relationship with Troops for Transportation; a Military Veteran CDL training school located in 9 states. To sign up, reach out to Sarah Haskin (sarahhaskin@totaltalentadvisors.com).
- 5. Driver Hiring Channel:** We recommend establishing partnership with Career Choice training schools near you. Career Choice is an Amazon funded upskilling program for Fulfilment Center Employees. Each year, 4K FC employees obtain their CDL license and this continues to be a rich driver recruitment channel for AFPs. Find more information [here](#).

Fountain—Applicant Tracking System (ATS)

What is Fountain? In April 2021, Amazon deployed a hiring product, Fountain, as a discretionary Value Added Service (VAS) tool dedicated to streamlining your entire end-to-end driver recruiting process. This includes steps such as sourcing, reviewing applications, screening, interviewing, and providing offer letters. We know that partners spend a significant amount of time on hiring activities each week, and we estimate that using Fountain will reduce time spent by up to 35%.

With Fountain, you can do the following all in one tool:

1. Post your job description to 80+ job sites (as well as the Amazon funded driver landing page afpjobs.amazon.com)
2. Easily track applicants from multiple job sites throughout the hiring process
3. Automatically screen applicants and schedule video interviews
4. Keep candidates engaged with automated emails and texts
5. Utilize suggested templates created by Amazon for job descriptions, interview questions, and preconfigured workflows
6. Use E-signatures for electronic document signing.

How can I sign up for Fountain? Fountain is subsidized for all partners. If you have not signed up for Fountain yet, you can do so [here](#). You will receive a one-time \$500 coupon for sourcing applicants using Fountain's job advertising feature that posts your job to more than 80 job sites. This coupon will be added automatically to your Fountain account after you complete the sign-up process. If you have questions, please reach out to your BC or find more information in the AFP Resource Center.

Compliance checks

After a driver signs the offer letter, they are moved into Relay for compliance check initiation before Day 1 start. Compliance check includes Background Checks (BGC) and Driver Qualification Files (DQF). We encourage you to initiate driver background checks and DQFs after the driver has passed the interview and signed the offer letter.

Driver background checks

AFPs are required to ensure their drivers meet program eligibility standards, which are verified through background checks (BGCs) conducted by the vendor First Advantage (FADV).

To reduce background check processing time with FADV, all new and existing AFPs should complete the following steps when onboarding within or onboarding drivers from WA, CO, and GA:

- Sign the WA, CO, and GA Motor Vehicle Records (MVR) consent certificates to allow FADV, a third-party background screening company, to access Department of Motor Vehicles records for drivers licensed from any of these three states.
- Complete an affidavit to get PennDOT approved (note this typically takes 30–45 days).
- Complete FADV's Pennsylvania MVR certificate.

Forms can be found in the AFP Resource Center at the following path: **Background Checks → Background Check Guide**.

1. AFPs should request drivers avoid using special characters for the driver's name field as this may lead to delays in processing and use an email unique from their Amazon Retail account (if they have one).
2. Background checks can take one to ten days, with a majority completing within seven days of the driver submission.
3. We also recommend that you confirm with the candidate that they have received the appropriate email from FADV to start their background check.
4. Establish a regular cadence for following up with the candidate and communicating an expected start date.
5. If you need assistance preparing the forms for background check, please contact:
 - Customer Care: afpowners.support@fadv.com or afpdrivers.support@fadv.com
 - Amazon Customer Success: AmazonCustomerSuccess@fadv.com

Driver qualification files

A Driver Qualification File (DQF) is a set of documents that the FMCSA requires be kept by any US trucking company—including AFPs—for every employed driver. These records need to be easily accessible for an authorized enforcement agent to verify that each driver is authorized to operate a Commercial Motor Vehicle (CMV). Having a compliant DQF is a DOT requirement for driving a CMV; each part of the DQF needs to be compliant for the overall DQF to be compliant. DQF compliance differs from the Amazon AFP Program background check in that 1) DQFs are a DOT regulatory requirement, and 2) DQFs include both one-time initial checks (application for employment, safety and performance history) along with ongoing checks and expiring documents such as a Medical Examiner's Certificate, clearinghouse queries, Annual Certificate of Violations, or Motor Vehicle Record. See below for a complete list of DQF components:

Driver Qualification File (DQF) Requirements			
	DOCUMENT	DESCRIPTION	REQUIRED
Prehire	Driver's application	Driver's preemployment application	DOT
	Road test	Road test and certificate. Commercial Drivers License can be used in lieu of road test	DOT
	Limited query consent	Driver's consent for the limited query search	Amazon
	MVR consent disclosure	Consent form for pulling MVRs	Amazon
	Driver license	Copy of the driver license	DOT
	Initial MVR	Initial MVR—acquired within 30 days of hire date	DOT
	Prior state MVR	An MVR needs to be in the file for 3 years of residency history	DOT
	Employee verification	Safety and Performance History Inquiry. Threeyear history of drug and alcohol violations in former safetysensitive functions with current and previous employers	DOT
	Medical card	Medical Examiner's Certificate & national registry confirmation	DOT
	Entry	Entrylevel training certificate: only required for drivers with less than one year of experience	DOT
	Initial limited clearinghouse results	Results for the driver's initial limited query search. Introduced in 2020	DOT
Ongoing	Medical card	Medical Examiner's Certificate	DOT
	Citations	Record of any on- or offduty citations	Amazon
	Annual MVR	Annual MVR	DOT
	Certificate of violations	Driver's certification of moving violations within the past 365 days	DOT
	Annual review	Annual review of the driver file	DOT
	Limited clearinghouse results	Results for the driver's initial ongoing query search. Introduced in 2020	DOT
Drug & Alcohol (D&A) Requirements			
	DOCUMENT	DESCRIPTION	REQUIRED
Prehire	Initial drug test	Results for prehire drug test	DOT
Ongoing	Drug test results	Any posthire drug test results. Random, postaccident, reasonable suspicion. Refusal is handled differently—refusal to test, not positive, gets handled in unique manner	DOT

The FMCSA and DOT require all trucking companies to implement drug and alcohol regulations. All CDL drivers must receive a negative preemployment drug test, and 60% are selected for random testing annually.

All AFPs are subject to DOT audits and investigations. New entrants (companies with less than 18 months of operations, including AFP Accelerator entrepreneurs) must pass a DOT New Entrant audit within 12 months. DQFs and Drug & Alcohol management are audit components. Failing an audit can result in DOT suspension or shutdown of operating authority.

Amazon has partnered with J.J. Keller (JJK), a value-added service paid for by Amazon, to manage DQFs and D&A programs for new AFPs. JJK provides an end-to-end solution including DOT-compliant driver applications, employee verification, clearinghouse registry checks, and ongoing compliance tracking. Per the Program Agreement, all new entrant AFPs must enroll with JJK for these services for their tenure.

After one year, AFPs may continue with JJK or choose another method for managing DQFs and Drug & Alcohol. This supports AFPs' ability to qualify applicants and meet FMCSA compliance requirements.

To enroll with JJK, complete this form, and a representative will schedule a welcome call to provide an overview and next steps.

Drug and alcohol testing

The Program Agreement requires all partners to comply with the FMCSA and US DOT rule 49 CFR Part 40. This rule requires an employer to conduct workplace drug and alcohol testing on all active drivers prior to them operating a Commercial Motor Vehicle.

All drug and alcohol testing must be a standard five-panel test that includes cannabis, opioids, phencyclidine, cocaine, and amphetamines. The test must be performed by a licensed third-party laboratory and reviewed by a licensed medical officer. The Program Agreement also requires partners to maintain appropriate records of acknowledgment of the five-panel drug test for each driver. These will be administered and shared with the TRC team.

For more guidance on drug and alcohol testing, we recommend that your company consult with your legal advisor.

Driver onboarding

We have included an onboarding checklist that your company and your drivers must complete before hauling their first Amazon load. Please reach out to your MMPM or BC if you have further questions.

1. Schedule and complete Driver Qualification Files (DQF) and Drug & Alcohol (DA) tests
2. Set up driver profile in Relay
3. Set up driver profile in ADP
4. Complete all mandatory trainings—safety, tractors equipment training, and electronic logging device usage. Training on Relay app usage, driver pre-registration, and tractor assignments in Relay
5. Review safety procedures with new driver
6. Driver training on reporting delays during the trip
7. Review Relay Operations Center/Driver Support Services procedures and guidelines with new driver
8. Assign the first AFP load to driver.

Amazon Relay

Amazon Relay (relay.amazon.com) is the hub of your business operations and allows you to manage your AFP account, onboard and schedule your drivers, and view your completed loads and payments.

Relay Portal – day-to-day operation

In this section you will find information on how to use the Relay Portal in your day-to-day operations. This includes how to find Relay Contracts as well as dispatching, routing, and Trip status information.

- **Learning:** Find the latest training content and courses on the portal.
- **User guides and FAQs:** To find the latest Relay portal FAQs and user guides go to: Support Center > Help > Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs). Scroll down to see the full list of FAQs.

AFP contracts

The process of issuing loads from Amazon to AFPs is primarily done through weekly contracts. The following are some common questions to help you understand the contract process.

When do I get my first contract? When do additional contracts come? Amazon typically asks AFPs to be ready to execute the first Sunday after their tractor handoff. Contracts are based on an operating week that starts on Sunday and ends on Saturday. Weekly contracts are finalized on Wednesday at 11am PT.

Rejecting loads

Rejecting loads impacts your performance scores and your scorecard. To minimize this, it is important that you follow the correct procedures. Before accepting loads from Amazon, carriers should proactively check that they have what is needed to execute the loads successfully. After accepting loads, carriers should update reason codes and load notes in real-time ensures that Amazon has visibility.

Before accepting loads, confirm the following: Does your company have drivers with available hours to execute the load? Can your company's drivers still execute the load that was already accepted with the correct hours of service (HOS)? Will your company's driver be on-time for the scheduled pickup time? Does your company have safe, reliable, and proper equipment based on the load available?

Asking yourself these questions before accepting loads will put you in a better position to be successful. If your company cannot complete accepted loads, please reject it as soon as possible (at the block level when able). By rejecting at the block level instead of at the load level, your company's acceptance score will only be impacted once, as opposed to multiple rejections for each load within that block.

Rejections should occur as soon as your company becomes aware that the loads cannot be completed. Specific training content with regards to rejections and their implications on your acceptance score can be found in Relay

Payments

AFP payments Standard Operating Procedure (SOP): There are two types of payments that Amazon uses to reimburse AFPs: weekly invoicing and one-time payments.

1. Weekly invoicing

- Partners get paid based on a variable rate (greater than or equal to 80 hours or under 80 hours) and a fixed rate (per tractor). There's no additional action required on a partner's end in order to get paid every week for the executed loads.
- In addition to a fixed weekly rate per tractor, partners' weekly payment is a combination of: **Number of blocks x number of hours x number of tractors**. For example, a partner with three Amazon-branded tractors will see a fixed weekly payment per tractor per week plus a variable payment of: hourly rate x (6 blocks x 13 hours x 3 tractors) every week excluding fuel and toll payments. Fuel and tolls costs are covered outside of the weekly invoice. Comdata fuel cards cover the fuel expenses at Amazon preferred fuel stations, which can be located on the Comdata mobile app. At Amazon fuel vendors there is no out-of-pocket expense for partners. For tolls, PC miler transponder covers the toll charges directly, too.

• Weekly invoice sample

The amounts listed in this informational guide are examples only. AFPs must independently set wage and bonus amounts to remain competitive.

Variable revenue:
80 hours or less

+

Planned hours

×

80 hours or less rate

Variable revenue:
81 hours or less

+

Incremental hours

×

81+ hour rate

Fixed revenue

+

Tractor count

×

Fixed weekly payment

Carrier: Hidden
SCAC: AFUNL

Bill to: Amazon Logistics, Inc.
1 Amazon Dr
Seattle, WA 32483

Dispute id.:
Invoice#: XX
Invoice date: Sep 8, 2021
Invoice total: \$14,718.74

Work period: Aug 29 - Sep 4, 2021
Payment status: Paid
Payment date: Sep 9, 2021
Work type: TENDERED
Pay Term: Net 7

Amazon Freight Partner - Payment Summary											
Domicile	Tractor #	Calendar Week *	Driver Type	Tractor Type	Tractor Rate (Per Week)	Duration (hr)		Hourly Rate (Per hr)		Accessorial**	Total Payment
						Total	Up to and incl. 80 hours	Hours over 80 hours	Up to and incl. 80 hours		
HOU	...00024MLH	Wk 36	SOLO1	BRANDED	490.00	78.00	78.00	0.00	\$ 37.75	\$ -	\$ 1,122.01
HOU	...00024MLH	Wk 36	SOLO1	BRANDED	490.00	78.00	78.00	0.00	\$ 37.75	\$ -	\$ 1,141.71
HOU	...00024MLK	Wk 36	SOLO1	BRANDED	490.00	78.00	78.00	0.00	\$ 37.75	\$ -	\$ 1,027.34
HOU	...00024MLL	Wk 36	SOLO1	BRANDED	490.00	78.00	78.00	0.00	\$ 37.75	\$ -	\$ 781.90
HOU	...000228BY	Wk 35	SOLO1	BRANDED	490.00	78.00	78.00	0.00	\$ 37.75	\$ -	\$ 163.49
HOU	...000228BX	Wk 36	SOLO1	BRANDED	26.00	26.00	26.00	0.00	\$ 37.75	\$ -	\$ 103.13
HOU	...000228BW	Wk 36	SOLO1	BRANDED	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 26.81
Total:											\$19,058.89

Adjustments & Deductions		
Type	Description	Total Payment
Adjustments	0 Resolved	\$ 0.00
Advanced fuel Purchase	23 Fuel Transactions	(\$ 4,376.16)
Adjustments & Deduction		(\$ 4,376.16)
Total:		\$14,718.74

* Reflects the week in which the hours began
** A detailed breakdown can be found in the Payment Details

- **Invoicing schedule:** AFPs are paid weekly for all Blocks executed and completed in a work week (Sunday 12 AM to Saturday 11:59 PM). Any Blocks that start on Saturday and complete on Sunday will be accounted for in the following week's payment.

• Timeline:

- Invoice is generated by Wednesday and is viewable/downloadable in Relay 4 Carrier.
- Partners receive payment by Friday.
- Partners have 30 days from the day of the load's scheduled invoice date to dispute.

2. One-time payments

- One-time payments (OTPs) are ad-hoc payments that are processed manually to reimburse partners for nonrecurring costs, such as:
 - Fuel adjustments
 - Bonus reimbursements
 - Contract rightsizing payouts.
- OTPs are not a part of the weekly contract invoice amount and are processed separately. Partners are notified via a remittance email to inform them of the payment that's going to be processed and deposited in their account. Remittance emails are descriptive enough to help partners reconcile and track the payments for ad-hoc, nonrecurring costs.
- These payments are not integrated with Relay, and partners can work with their MMPMs directly if they have any questions regarding their OTPs.

Relay Operations Center (ROC)

Partners needing immediate operational assistance should contact Relay Operations Center (ROC). To do so, go into the Relay portal, visit the Trips page, and select **'Ask a Question.'**

You can expect a response/callback within 10 minutes. Drivers can utilize Relay Assistant (RA) is a chatbot within the Relay portal and app that can assist you with in-transit trip support issues. RA is integrated directly onto your Trips page. You can describe your issue to the RA chatbot and answer clarifying questions which the chatbot may ask, with the goal of resolving a trip issue without needing to speak to an Amazon agent. With RA, carriers can

describe the issue they are facing to the chatbot. The chatbot may ask clarifying questions to ensure the issue is clearly defined.

Then, depending on the issue, one of the following will happen:

1. RA will provide load information if the support request was for information
2. RA will automatically resolve the issue through trip modifications
3. RA will create a support request to ROC with all of the details gathered through the chatbot so that the agent has context of the issue when working the support case
4. RA will direct the carrier to the correct way to get help for issues not related to in-transit trips, such as performance or payment disputes

Relay app

The following section covers the steps for drivers to set up their Relay access through the Relay mobile app, available on both [iOS](#) and [Android](#), and common questions about the Relay app. AFPs should ensure their drivers use the app for all loads.

Amazon recommends that AFPs become familiar with this process, which will likely create opportunities to build AFP driver support in going through these steps. It's recommended that you print out this section and distribute it to your company's drivers.

App setup

After a driver is entered into the driver roster of a partner's Relay account, the driver will receive an **email**. The driver has seven days to click **'Get Started'** in the email to complete their driver profile. After seven days, the link will expire and the partner will need to send a new email invite.

After a driver visits the 'Get Started' link, they'll be directed to **download the Relay app** onto their phone. They can do this through either the [Apple App Store](#) or the [Google Play Store](#). After the app has been downloaded, and in order to use the app, the driver will need to **open the app**.

Once in the app, the driver will need to follow the prompts on each screen. If the driver has previously set up their Relay profile, they will need to **log in** and **enter the invitation code** that arrived in their email.

To sync their driver profile with the company's Relay account, the driver will need to **tap the menu icon** (three lines) located in the upper left corner of their screen. From there, the driver will then need to **tap 'Add Carrier'** in the left menu.

This will take the driver to the invite code screen, where the driver will **enter the code received** in the invitation email. Once the driver **taps the 'Submit' button**, they will be directed to complete their driver profile.

Relay will ask for a driver's permission to access location as well as send notifications. Location data is used to provide turn-by-turn directions, track ETA and delays, provide load statuses to partners, and make real-time scheduling updates. This helps keep drivers safe and Amazon on track. If the location services are not enabled, detention requests may be denied as it is required the app is used on all loads. Drivers should **select 'Always Allow'**.

Notifications will alert the driver, in real-time, if there are changes made to the load. For example, if a load is canceled, delayed, or showing late, the driver can opt to receive sounds notifications, screen alerts, or even both. We recommend drivers **allow notifications** when prompted and then adjust their preferences in their phone settings. Drivers will be notified of load readiness only if they've gone through the check-in process via the Relay mobile app.

Notifications will also communicate safety tips as well as any updates or changes to Amazon processes or procedures.

Note: If at any point the app isn't working correctly, try completely closing the app or powering the phone off and then back on. If this doesn't fix the problem, contact the Support Center through the menu.

Finalizing setup

Once the setup is complete, drivers can be assigned loads by your company. Any assigned loads will appear in the app.

Note: Please remember, it is the driver's responsibility to enter the equipment numbers (tractor and trailer) for all loads they are assigned.

Load status

If the driver does not have any loads assigned, the screen will say, **'No future loads assigned'**. Only the upcoming load will be available for preregistration and only within 24 hours of the scheduled pickup. If the driver does have loads assigned, the screen will say **'Start work'**.

Drivers should **log in to the Relay app** when they arrive at their vehicle to begin loads. The driver will select their Trip and tap it to start work. Drivers can view their assigned loads by day by **tapping the 'View Schedule' button**.

During preregistration a driver can either select a vehicle from their profile, or **add a new vehicle by tapping 'Add'**. If adding a new vehicle, then the driver will be prompted to complete all vehicle information and **confirm by tapping 'Save'**. As a best practice, drivers should double check the equipment type matches the driver's current vehicle.

If selecting a semi-tractor, the driver will need to be aware of vehicle height and also need to select if they are bringing in an empty trailer. If driving a semi without a trailer, a driver should continue directly to the Navigate screen by tapping 'Next'. If driving a semi bringing an empty trailer, the driver should select **'Yes'** then tap **'Next'** and provide the **trailer information on the next screen**.

If a driver is bringing in a trailer, they should select how many and then search by the **trailer ID or license plate number**. Once a trailer is used it will be available in the search results. If the trailer is not listed it can be **added manually**.

Once the equipment has been preregistered the app will present the Navigate screen. After 10 seconds, the app will automatically advance to navigation and guide the driver to the pickup location. The driver can also **tap 'Navigate'** to start the Trip. If the driver needs to change the vehicle or trailer information they can do so by **tapping the question mark symbol and then selecting 'Edit Pre-registration.'**

Driver preregistration

Drivers can also add vehicles to their profile at any time by tapping the menu icon (three lines) located in the upper left corner of their screen, and then tapping 'Your Vehicles.' The driver should complete the preregistration by adding their tractor information.

Note: Drivers should make sure to enter all equipment information prior to beginning navigation to the origin. They should also ensure the information entered is accurate to help reduce check-in and check-out times. Accurate preregistration will help speed up the check-in process.

Using the app

GPS navigation will detect when a driver is onsite at a yard. A **QR code will be generated** for the yard associate to scan. After the QR code has been scanned, the driver should tap **'Tap after scan'** at the bottom of the screen.

If a driver arrives too early, the yard may not have the capacity for the driver to wait. In this event, the app will alert the driver when their load is ready. After check-in, it's the driver's responsibility to ensure all trailer information is accurate.

When the trailer is ready, the app will instruct the driver to proceed to the pickup location. If a dock door or location is not provided, the driver should check in with a yard associate.

The driver must verify the trailer information listed in the app corresponds to the trailer they're hooking up to. To do so they should **follow the app prompts**.

On some loads, **an electronic bill of lading (eBOL) will be generated**, and the driver will be prompted to **review and confirm** it. This is necessary to do before checking out. Once the eBOL has been confirmed, the eBOL will be accessible at the top of the **Check Out and Drive To screens**. Only the eBOL for the current load is accessible.

When dropping off a trailer and picking up a new trailer, the driver should **tap 'Drop off trailer'** once done dropping and then proceed by **entering the trailer ID** for the new load. If a trailer is not assigned, the driver should see the **ship clerk**.

If leaving with a trailer, the driver should have an **Amazon yard associate scan their QR code** to check the driver out. The driver should **tap after the gate scan and then tap again to confirm** the end of the tour.

Navigating to non-Amazon sites

The following provides instructions on app usage when picking up or delivering. The driver should check the **pickup and drop off** instructions before and after arrival to view all necessary location and load information. Non-Amazon sites do not use the Amazon load ID or QR codes.

Arriving at non-Amazon sites before check-in

Location services will detect the driver's arrival to the site. The driver should tap on the **'Pickup Instructions'** to see details. Pickup and reference numbers are **visible after arrival**.

The driver can scroll down the screen to see full details. After the guard shack receives the pickup number the driver should **tap 'Tap after check in.'**

Dropping off a loaded or empty trailer at a non-Amazon site (after being checked in)

Drop-off information will be available at check-in. Drivers should **tap 'Drop off trailer'** after the trailer is dropped. An empty trailer will not need a bill of lading (BOL). A clear proof of delivery is required for payment. Information must be visible.

Picking up a trailer after dropping at a non-Amazon site

Yard passes are not available at non-Amazon sites. The **number of the pickup trailer** should be entered. The driver should enter in all the **trailer information**. Drivers should not depart without entering the information.

After a driver departs, they should **tap 'Tap after check out.'** Drivers should make sure not to do this more than once.

Navigating to a non-Amazon site – live loading

Pickup instructions are visible by tapping on **'Pickup Instructions.'** After checked in with the Pickup number, a driver should tap **'Tap after check in.'**

Additional information will be available from the site. The driver should tap **'Loaded'** after the trailer has been loaded.

Drop-off instructions are available after departure. Delivery details are available after GPS detects arrival.

Drivers should tap **'Unloaded'** only when the trailer has been unloaded.

A picture **MUST** be taken of the signed and dated BOL. To do so, drivers should tap **'Open camera.'** The picture **MUST be a clear image with ALL information readable.**

Relay app self-help

The following provides instructions on how to address common scenarios within the app. AFPs are encouraged to share this information with drivers to help them resolve any app issues.

How do I get started?

Action:

1. You'll need an invite code via email from your partner to get started. If you haven't received this, let your partner know.
2. Download app via the Apple App Store or Google Play Store.
3. Enter invite code from the email.
4. Follow the app's prompts to get started.

Need to report a problem? You can report non-urgent problems or provide feedback on any aspect of your experience.

Action:

- Select 'Provide Feedback' from the main menu. Providing feedback can be done at anytime from the main menu after Trip is completed.

Forgot your password? You can reset your password within the app.

Action:

- Tap 'Forgot Password'. Retrieve the one-time password from your email. Enter the password into the app.

If a load was cancelled: When an upcoming load is canceled or changed, you will receive a notification of the change within five hours of the scheduled time. No action needed. Wait for the app to update with new tour information, which will typically populate in about 15 minutes.

Need to review previous Trips? The app provides load history of work for the previous two weeks with details on prior Trips and loads.

Action:

- View load history by selecting "Load History" from the main menu.

Reporting delays: If you have a breakdown, need to take an Hours of Service mandated break, have mechanical issues or other unforeseen delays, you can report them in the app.

Action:

- Park safely. Select 'Report A Delay' from the Trip screen. Select the reason for the delay. Select the time when you will move again.

What happens when I arrive? GPS will automatically detect your arrival at the yard. Relay provides automated access to yards upon arrival, based on your verified location.

Action:

Tap 'Tap after scan' once scanned in when at the site. QR code may not be used at all sites.

Does Relay Navigation provide truck-friendly routes? Yes. Relay Navigation uses routes that are optimized for commercial vehicles, accounting for low bridges, road classes, residential areas, and weight limits.

Action:

- Use Relay Navigation for every Trip, even short and known routes. To do so tap 'Start' on the Route screen every time you start a Trip.

Will Relay Navigation route around hazards and disruptions? Yes. When a driver enters the vicinity of a known hazard or disruption marked by a geofence, they will receive visual alerts via push notifications (if the app is not currently active) or in-app banners (if the app is active).

How do I contact Relay Operations Center with an urgent matter? For urgent matters, access the 'Request a Callback' feature located in the Support Center of the app menu. You can select from a series of prompts regarding their issue to receive a call from a trained support agent.

Using your ELD

Federal regulations require the use of a certified ELD for all heavy-duty commercial trucks involved in interstate commerce to improve the safety of drivers on the road. Per regulations, drivers are ultimately responsible for their own HOS logs. Your company is expected to check for accuracy, audit logs, and coach drivers as needed. If drivers are performing their functions correctly and in a timely manner, their HOS logs should be accurate with minimal effort required from your company.

How do I place an order for a device that supports the ELD app?

Your company can place an order for devices with either Verizon Wireless, T-Mobile, or AT&T. Please find the cost and details of the device and unlimited data usage plans within the flyers in the accompanying materials.

To place an order with Verizon, please email the sales team at amazon.afp.sales@verizonwireless.com with your company's legal entity name, SCAC, and your name and email address.

To place an order with T-Mobile, please register your company information via the [T-Mobile Account Form Page](#).

To place an order with AT&T, please register your company information via the [AT&T AFP Account Page](#).

The respective sales teams will reach out to you via email and phone within 24 hours to discuss the offer, finalize the order, and explain the delivery process. Devices will be delivered and operational within 24 hours of finalizing the invoice and purchase order.

Note: Partners have access to large discounts on monthly service through three phone partners (Verizon, T-Mobile, or AT&T). Partners are required to have a corporate mobile plan, and they're encouraged to use Amazon's discounts.

When should I place the order?

Once you receive communication from your company's BC on your tentative start date, you can place the order for your devices with Verizon, T-Mobile, or AT&T.

Who should I call if I don't receive the devices or have issues activating them?

The mobile carrier your company selected will provide your company with a sales team contact to help with placing your order, managing your delivery, and activating the devices. Please reach out to this dedicated contact with all questions or issues relating to delivery status or device activation.

Is mobile data and voice plan part of the offering?

Yes, unlimited mobile data and voice plan usage are included with Verizon, T-Mobile, and AT&T as part of this offering. Please refer to the provided marketing materials for additional details related to pricing, speed, and availability.

Is insurance included?

Insurance for the devices is not provided as part of this offering. Your company may purchase insurance separately through Verizon, T-Mobile, or AT&T.

Can I just order one device per tractor instead of one per driver?

To ensure there are no compliance gaps (Hours of Service, Unassigned Drive Time, or clock in/clock outs), we highly recommend one device per driver.

Set up each device: If a phone doesn't have Relay already installed, the partner should set up the Relay app on each device. If you choose an iOS device, understand that Apple IDs are not connected directly to devices, so if a device previously used by one driver is given to a different driver in the future, the new driver can connect a new Apple ID to the device. Because all the devices are linked to a partner's account, there shouldn't be an issue if drivers want to configure their phone's settings—calendars, apps, settings, etc.—according to their personal preference.

Tractor maintenance

The AFP Program uses multiple makes and models of tractors. The make and model of tractors assigned to an AFP are dependent on factors such as fueling infrastructure for CNG vehicles.

Inspections and preventative maintenance

The MCS scheduled maintenance team will coordinate proactive maintenance for the tractors, although there may be contractual differences in maintenance support for rentals.

MCS will coordinate directly with our service vendors and AFPs on the following preventative maintenance services:

- 1. Annual inspection** - DOT requires an annual inspection of all tractors. This inspection does not usually require tractors to be taken off site. The tractors' annual inspection does not remain valid until the last day of a month, but expires 365 days from the last annual inspection.
- 2. Biennial Inspection of Terminals (BIT) inspection** - This is required for equipment operated in the state of California and must be completed every 90 days. This inspection does not usually require tractors to be taken off-site. This is equivalent to a DOT annual inspection.
- 3. CNG tank inspection** - A visual CNG cylinder inspection is required for all CNG tractors. This inspection does not require tractors to be taken off site. The visual CNG cylinder inspection is to be performed annually. This inspection remains valid until the last day of a month and expires one year from the last annual tank inspection.

Preventative Maintenance-B (PM-B)

The service includes the asset check-point inspection, oil, oil filter, water filter, fuel filters, and spark plug service, and must be performed under the condition of a cold engine. The schedule maintenance team will plan service for units within 28 days prior to the due date. Depending on your site, tractors may need to be taken offsite for service; however, we will complete service onsite whenever possible. The goal is to complete a PM-B service within six hours (diesel engine) or 12-15 hours (CNG engine), plus transit time. The Service Level Agreement (SLA) for offsite time is a minimum of 24 hours for diesel and 48 hours for CNG units. In the event other mechanical issues

are discovered during the course of normal service, the expectation is that the service provider will inform the MCS scheduled maintenance team and the SLA will extend beyond the timeframe described above.

Unplanned maintenance/ mechanical defects

If a defect is found during a pre-trip or post-trip inspection, the AFP driver should submit it via a Driver Vehicle Inspection Report (DVIR) in the Relay app, which will automatically create a work order for the defect(s). Once that unit has an open work order, the MCS team will track it with the vendor to completion. If a defect is found outside of the pre/post trip inspection process, the AFP driver or the AFP carrier is to use Click 2 Call (C2C) via the Relay app to report the mechanical defect to an AFP dedicated associate. DSS will then capture that defect and ensure that the asset reflects as unavailable in Amazon's internal systems. Once that unit has an open work order, the MCS team will track that unit with the vendor to completion. During the repair process, MCS will enter estimated time of completion (ETC) dates that will be visible via Relay for assets that are down.

Partner Managed Repairs (PMR)

AFP Carriers can leverage Partner Managed Repairs (PMR) to reduce cost, downtime and mechanical rejections. AFP Drivers can complete repairs such as changing air lines, greasing fifth wheels, replacing mudflaps, and replacing windshield wipers. Additional in-scope repairs can be completed by a certified technician. AFP Carriers will pay upfront for qualifying repairs and submit a reimbursement request within 14 calendar days. More information can be found in the AFP Resource Center.

Mechanical rejections

If a downed tractor is going to lead to a mechanical rejection, you'll need to report it via C2C in the Relay app to the ROC DSS team. The best way to prevent mechanical rejections before they happen is through a thorough and consistent DVIR. A proper pre-trip and post-trip DVIR is your first line of defense – it catches issues like low tire tread, broken lights, air leaks, and brake problems before they become rejections. But the DVIR is only as good as the process behind it. As an owner, it's important to inspect what you expect – build a routine audit process to review your drivers' DVIRs for completeness and accuracy, spot-check vehicles against what was reported, and hold drivers accountable when inspections are missed or rushed. Partners who treat the DVIR as a real operational tool rather than a checkbox consistently see fewer mechanical surprises, fewer rejections, and more loads successfully executed.

Tractor handoff requirements and process

Your company's BC will work with you to develop a timeline for hiring drivers and adding vehicles to your company's fleet. Once the ramp plan has been developed and agreed upon, you will make the request for new vehicles. They will inform you of the date for your company's first handoff. Handoffs may be completed early if tractors are available and if you have drivers ready.

Handoff email

Once handoff details have been compiled, you will receive a handoff confirmation email. This email will contain all vehicle information such as the unit ID, original equipment manufacturer type, vehicle identification number, license plate number, license state, and more.

The email will also include instructions on where to go for handoff, when to be there, how to check in at the site, and who you will be meeting. It may also list steps you need to take prior to receiving tractors. Please be sure to review all attachments and follow all instructions listed.

We recommend that you print the handoff confirmation email sent to you and bring it to the handoff site. Although the majority of the fleet is made up of Amazon-branded tractors, the AFP Program does leverage other providers to help make up the overall fleet. If your company does receive non-Amazon-branded tractors, these units are still treated the same as a branded tractor.

There will be critical steps to update your insurance information with these providers listed in the confirmation email. If your company's insurance provider requires a copy of your Lease Agreement, please inform Relay Operations Center through the 'Request a Callback' feature in the Relay app and inform your company's MMPM. The Lease Agreement will be included in the confirmation email if it has been requested.

Handoff day

Preparation: Make sure you bring all required documents and materials with you to the handoff site. These include:

1. Copies of the Branded Vehicle Receipt for each vehicle
2. Copies of the Inspection Checklist for each vehicle
3. A printed copy of the confirmation email
4. Proof of insurance for each vehicle
5. Class 2, high-visibility vests for you and each driver
6. Masks or face coverings for you and each driver
7. In addition, make sure all drivers bring their active CDL

Important reminders

Your handoff will be slotted between 8 AM and 4 PM local time. Ensure your personal schedule is clear on the handoff date. The handoff will take place at an Amazon Partner Parking (APP) location. Ensure you and your company's drivers are respectful of any Amazon staff present. You are responsible for any drivers you bring to an APP.

Handoffs at Amazon Partner Parking (APP) sites

When you go to your APP location for vehicle handoff, you will primarily be interacting with an on-site maintenance vendor, such as Amerit. These technicians are the point of contact for on-site maintenance as well as your contact for handoff day and will be able to assist with any questions you may have during the vehicle inspection and handoff. The same safety requirements apply to Amazon yard and APP facilities.

Checking in

- Please ensure that you reach the pickup site five minutes before your appointment
- To avoid traffic congestion, do not arrive earlier than 10 minutes before your appointment
- On your arrival at the pickup location, please park your vehicle in one of the visitor parking spots and head inside
- Please ensure you enter visitor/employee parking
- Do not use the commercial truck entrance unless your point of contact specifically requests it and provides instructions on how to do so. Personal vehicles are generally not allowed to use this entrance.
- Inform security at the entrance who you are meeting
- Show security your printed email
- If needed, ask them to radio the 'TOM team' to alert them you've arrived, and ask TOM to notify your point of contact
- For APP locations, connect with security at the entrance, and proceed to the designated location where the technician will be. You can find the technician contact information in your confirmation email.
- Your point of contact will guide you to the tractors. Stay with them and be mindful that none of your drivers get lost or wander.
- Once you have arrived at the vehicle(s), the tractor inspection(s) will begin

Checking out

- Perform the inspection, complete three copies of the Inspection Checklist, complete three copies of the Branded Vehicle Receipt, and provide your Amazon point of contact with one copy of each. Provide the driver with one copy of each document as well as the insurance card for the appropriate tractor.
- Once paperwork is completed, drivers will be given the keys and are ready to check out
- The guard shack will likely ask to see your paperwork. Drivers can show the Amazon-branded vehicle receipt; however, their copy needs to remain inside the vehicle upon exit.
- Your drivers are now clear to drive your new rental vehicles back to your company's home site

Tractor parking

Amazon must approve any AFP Parking location. Drivers can use the Relay app to quickly locate safe, approved parking spots. Refer to the Program Agreement for compliance with parking requirements.

Audit and compliance requirements

The TRC team conducts compliance audits to review partners' adherence to aspects of AFP Agreements; the Amazon Supplier Code of Conduct; and federal, state, and local regulations.

Helpful contacts and links:

- AFP TRC contact: afpcompliance-trc@amazon.com
- AFP Resource Center: <https://amazonfreightpartner.force.com/afpresourcecenter/s/>

Risk topics that are investigated by TRC include: **(1) Wage and Benefit Compliance (WBC) audits.** These are typically performed weekly or biweekly in accordance with your company's payroll schedule. **(2) Amazon inspects your driver ADP Payroll data** in compliance with Program Agreement section 20. **(3) TRC may audit many aspects of WBC compliance, such as:**

- 1. Hourly wages** (as per minimum domicile rate stated on your rate card): Per the Program Agreement, Section 20(a), Your company must pay its non-exempt employees based on an hourly compensation structure. That amount must not be less than the AFP Program Wage Table provided by Amazon, Section 20(b). The wage- and benefit-related audit items are based on Amazon minimum requirements and operate as contractual minimums. AFPs are free to offer higher wages to remain competitive in the labor market.
- 2. ADP time and attendance use:** Your company is required to electronically track and record the hours worked by employees in ADP, Section 20 (d).
- 3. PTO accrual:** You must offer all employees paid time off (PTO). Accrual of PTO must begin on the first day of employment and accrue at a rate of no less than 4% per worked hour, Section 20(f).
- 4. Non-mandatory deductions:** You are not allowed to make any prohibited deductions from employee's wages outside of what is allowed by applicable law, Section 20(c).
- 5. Overtime pay:** You must pay your employees for all time worked in a week. If a driver worked over 40 hours overtime, you must pay them at a rate equal to at least 1.5 times the employee's regular rate of pay as defined by the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA), Section 20(a).
- 6. ADP time and attendance versus AFP Relay hours:** All hours worked must be logged in ADP. To accurately record their time, your company's drivers must log into ADP and Relay at the beginning of each shift and at the end of each shift log out of Relay and ADP. Amazon will compare the two timetables to validate the driver is paid for the full time worked.

These audits will help determine adherence to the Program Agreement. Proper wage and benefit practices can contribute to employee morale, improving employee retention in the long term.

To perform the wage and benefit audit, TRC has view-only access to a subset of reports in your company's ADP

account. Amazon can view the necessary information to perform the audit, but they do not have access to make any changes. Amazon will not provide guidance on how to process your payroll. Please contact ADP for specific processing questions.

Healthcare audit

As per the Program Agreement, your company must offer healthcare insurance to full time (30+ hours a week) drivers within the first 30 days of employment. Each AFP must enroll in a qualified healthcare program that is deemed affordable and minimum value by the Affordable Care Act. Each month you will receive an email from TRC requesting you provide specific healthcare documents. Your company's first healthcare audit will take place 60 days from tractor handoff. This upload should be a copy of the bound healthcare policy documents that include plan details as well as cost (e.g. summary of benefits coverage), and a letter from your healthcare provider that evidences the effective date of your company's policy. Once provided, this will not be requested again until the policy renewal date. If you are struggling to find affordable healthcare, Amazon has a value-added service of approved healthcare offerings through Woodruff Sawyer/Decisely.

Annual Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) filing

The purpose of the OSHA audit is to ensure that all partners are adhering to the Program Agreement and federal, state, and local requirements requiring all AFPs to file their OSHA Accident and recordkeeping logs 300, 300a and 301. This audit is conducted annually utilizing your proof of filing submission. If an AFP does not complete the OSHA upload before the March 2 deadline, they will receive an enforcement action. The required Sentix Training, AFP Newsletter, and initiation request are useful references.

Periodic Audits/Point in Time (PiT)

The PiT audit program inspects multiple categories of Program Agreement requirements for driver eligibility, AFP eligibility, and AFP operations. PiT audits are completed periodically, generally within 90 days of entry in the AFP Program, and annually, at a minimum. To help set your company up for success, you'll be assigned a dedicated auditor during this process. They will invite you to an optional audit kickoff. We strongly recommend that you or a representative of your company attend the kickoff. During this one-on-one meeting, you or your dedicated auditor will review required documents and help with any questions you may have. During the PiT audit cycle, Amazon will stay in frequent communication with you and will send emails or calendar invites with a list of sampled drivers, required documents, and deadlines. Your company will need to upload required audit documents by the deadline in the email. The list of required audit documents is located in the AFP Resource Center.

Random Drug Testing (RDT)

The Random Drug testing is required by TRC quarterly utilizing JJ Keller access to Drug and Alcohol Clearing house data and response. AFPs will receive notice that their driver was selected at random at the start of each quarter with alcohol test performed before, during and after safety sensitive functions. Upon selection, drivers must immediately report to a collection site. Refusal to test or a positive result is reported to the Drug and Alcohol Clearing house and leads to immediate removal of safety sensitive functions. The AFP will receive CAP enforcement for drivers who did not comply with or respond to testing requested.

Driver log audits

The TRC team conducts frequent audits of ELD logs to review Hours of Service (HOS) compliance. TRC will audit to review for Unassigned Drive Time (UDT), compliance to HOS standards such as driving more than 11 hours in a shift, operating a Commercial Motor Vehicle after 14 hours in a shift, taking a 30-minute break after driving eight hours, and more, as required by the Program Agreement.

As an AFP, you are required to:

1. Ensure all of your company's drivers adhere to HOS requirements, utilize their ELD as required, and complete any administrative requirements (e.g. reconciling of all UDT, certification of ELD logs) in accordance with FMCSA timelines and regulations.

2. Review your company's drivers' ELD logs to confirm they are compliant with HOS requirements and work with drivers to improve HOS compliance as needed.
3. Your company's MMPM will review HOS audit results with you during your weekly calls.

Add as the next sentence: HOS compliance violations can result in coaching or a CAP, with specific actions required HOS compliance violations can result in coaching or a CAP, with specific actions required to remedy the noncompliance or, based on the severity or pervasiveness of violations, can lead to a Breach of Contract (BOC) or exit from the AFP Program.

Exits and suspensions

The chart below lists reasons that could lead to an AFP being exited from the program, which are outlined in the Program Agreement. Please note, this list is not exhaustive. Please refer to the AFP Program Agreement for updates as they become available.

AFP Terms of Service	Description
5(c)	AFP asks to voluntarily exit the program
5(d)(A)	Failure to cure a breach of the Program Agreement within 30 days of receiving written notice of the breach
5(d)(B)	Failure to meet Program Policy performance metrics for a sustained period of time
5(d)(C)	Company or personnel violates any applicable law
5(d)(D)	Company's safety rating becomes "Conditional", "Unsatisfactory", or "Unfit" or fails to meet safety metrics in the Program Agreement
5(d)(E)	Provides information that is not true and complete, or engages in fraudulent behavior
5(d)(F)	Amazon closes or materially reduces deliver volume at an fulfillment center
5(d)(G)	Repeated Program Agreement breaches regardless of one or more of the breaches being cured
5(d)(H)	Breaching Program Agreement prior to launch; failure to comply in a timely manner with any requirements prior to providing services
5(d)(I)	Failure to pay in a timely manner any amounts that are due and payable to employees or third party Vendors

AFP voluntary exit policy

As referenced in the Program Agreement, your company may terminate the AFP agreement at any time and for any reason by giving Amazon at least 60 days' prior written notice; however, your company may not terminate this Agreement without cause (including by providing a Termination Notice) with an effective date of termination during any November 1 through January 15 period, and any termination that would otherwise become effective during that period will be suspended until the next-occurring January 16.

AFP termination and suspension policy

As referenced in the Program Agreement, Amazon may terminate or suspend (or otherwise restrict your company's ability to participate in the Program) this Agreement by providing written notice to your company, (A) if your company breaches this Agreement (including, for the avoidance of doubt, any Program Policy) and fails to cure the breach (if the breach is capable of being cured) within 30 days of receiving written notice of the breach from Amazon, (B) if your company fails to meet the Performance Metrics set out in the Program Agreement for a sustained period of time, (C) if your company or any of its Personnel violates any applicable Law, (D) if your company's Safety Rating becomes "Conditional", "Unsatisfactory", or "Unfit" or your company receives written notification from a governing authority of a proposed downgrade of your Safety Rating to any of those categories or if your company otherwise fails to meet the Safety Metrics set out in the Program Policies or any of Amazon's safety standards or requirements, (E) if any information that your company or its Personnel provides to Amazon (including in connection with Amazon's vetting and onboarding processes) is not true and complete in all material respects or if your company otherwise engages in fraudulent behavior, (F) if we decide to close, or materially reduce the delivery volume at, any fulfillment center or other distribution point from which your company provides Services, (G) if your company repeatedly breaches this Agreement (including, for the avoidance of doubt, any policy within the Program Agreement), whether or not your company cures one or more of the breaches, (H) at any time prior to your company beginning to provide Services under this Agreement, if you breach or your company breaches this Agreement (including, for the avoidance of doubt, any policy within the Program Agreement) or if you or your company fails to comply in a timely manner with any requirements of the Program communicated by Amazon that must be completed prior to your company beginning to provide Services, or (I) if your company fails to timely pay any amounts that are due and payable to any employee or third-party vendor (including any vendor in connection with any Third Party Offering (defined in the any policy within the Program Agreement)) that provides equipment, goods, or services to your company. In addition, Amazon may suspend (or otherwise restrict) your company's ability to participate in the Program immediately in connection with any investigation of your company's account or practices, by providing written notice to your company.